CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

Issue 007 Monday, November 9, 2026 · Biweekly, 4 pages

Practices

Dental · Veterinary · Aesthetics · Chiropractic & Physical Therapy · Optometry & Vision · Behavioral & Mental Health

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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BACKGROUND SIGNAL
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

RULE

CMS's final 2027 fee schedule, issued November 4, cuts the Medicare conversion factor 2.31% to $32.6286 and delays its limit on contracted remote-monitoring staff to January 1, 2029.

CMS issued the final 2027 Medicare physician fee schedule on November 4, effective January 1, 2027. The conversion factor falls to $32.6286 from $33.4009 (2.31%) for most clinicians and to $32.9548 from $33.5675 (1.83%) for qualifying APM participants. In July CMS had proposed cuts of 1.68% and 1.19%.

The cut follows expiry of the one-year 2.5% increase that applied in 2026; statutory updates of 0.25% (0.75% for APM participants) and a 0.12% negative adjustment partly offset it. G2211 becomes modifier B1, adding 16% to the visit payment, or 32% with modifier B2 for Shared Savings Program and LEAD ACO clinicians.

Remote therapeutic monitoring is limited to established patients, with a separately reportable initiating visit, from 2027. The requirement that clinical staff be employed by the billing practice rather than contracted is delayed to January 1, 2029. When a visit and a 0-day procedure share a date, the lower-paid service is cut 20%.

Traditional MIPS reporting ends with the CY 2031 performance period, and clinicians have through CY 2030 to move to MIPS Value Pathways or an Advanced APM. Federal Register publication was scheduled for November 9 (document 2026-22743).

What to do about it: Pull your 2026 Medicare paid claims by code and reprice them at $32.6286 (or $32.9548 if you are a qualifying APM participant) to see the conversion-factor cut alone. Flag every claim where a visit and a minor procedure land on the same date. If a vendor staffs your remote monitoring, get written confirmation of how it will meet the initiating-visit and established-patient rules in 2027, and put the January 1, 2029 staffing date in the contract. Ask each major commercial payer whether its 2027 fee schedule tracks the Medicare conversion factor, and get the answer in writing before you sign a renewal. Read the Federal Register text of document 2026-22743 for your own codes.

HHS: CMS finalizes 2027 Medicare physician fee schedule · Applied Policy: CY 2027 PFS final rule summary · Medical Economics: final 2027 fee schedule cuts pay

DENTAL

TWO ITEMS

INSURANCE

Colorado's governor published a 2027-28 budget on November 1 that would end adult Medicaid dental coverage and the state's senior dental program, Becker's Dental Review reported November 3.

Why it matters: The budget line reads "eliminate coverage for adult services," saving $214.8 million, and a separate cut would end the senior dental program, saving $16.7 million; Becker's frames the first as adult Medicaid dental coverage. Colorado already capped adult dental benefits at $3,000 and cut dental rates 2% through legislation effective in July. The budget is a proposal. Colorado practices: count your adult Medicaid and senior-program patients and their share of collections, and tell patients with open treatment plans what is proposed.

Becker's Dental: Colorado governor targets Medicaid dental

MONEY

A JAMA Health Forum study published October 16 found states save only about 20 to 50 cents for every $1 cut from fee-for-service Medicaid dental spending, depending on the federal match.

Why it matters: Becker's Dental Review summarized the study October 19 and again October 28. The federal share of fee-for-service dental spending ran from 50.4% to 79.4% between 2013 and 2024, with a median of 66.1%. In West Virginia, eliminating adult benefits would cut about $4.1 million of spending but save the state about $0.91 million and forgo about $3.2 million in federal funds. The data omit managed care, where most adult services are delivered. If your state is weighing dental rate or benefit cuts, send your Medicaid agency and legislators these figures with the study date.

Becker's Dental: Medicaid dental math costs states more · Becker's Dental: 6 dental Medicaid, Medicare updates

VETERINARY

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

FDA issued an emergency use authorization on November 3 for fluralaner chewable tablets (Bravecto) to treat New World screwworm infestations in dogs and puppies, by veterinary prescription only.

Why it matters: The authorization went to Intervet Inc. and stays in effect until FDA revokes it or HHS ends the emergency declaration. FDA says isoxazolines such as fluralaner are commonly used and safe for most dogs but have been linked to muscle tremors, loss of coordination and seizures, and that monitoring them takes professional expertise. FDA's announcement links a veterinarian fact sheet and an adverse-event fact sheet. Read both, add the neurologic-reaction warning to your consent forms, and tell front-desk staff that visible maggots or a foul odor in a wound means a same-day exam.

dvm360: FDA authorizes fluralaner for screwworm in dogs

DEMAND

An Elanco survey fielded October 16-21 found 93% of dog and cat owners kept or raised pet spending over three months, while 38% bought pet medications outside the clinic.

Why it matters: Elanco, which sells pet health products, released the survey November 6 (2,018 adults, 1,495 of them dog or cat owners). Only 7% would cut pet health spending if money got tight, against 54% who would cut dining out. Purchase channels named were in-person vet clinics 37%, online pet specialty pharmacies 31% and vet online pharmacy home delivery 17%. Just 3% gave discounts or rebates as a reason to switch medication; a doctor's recommendation ranked first. Put the clinician's medication recommendation in writing on every plan, and price your home-delivery option against the online pharmacies.

dvm360: Pet health is the last expense owners would cut

AESTHETICS

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

HHS announced interim enforcement discretion for compounding six peptides, BPC-157, Epitalon, KPV, MOTS-c, Semax and TB-500, if safeguards are met, American Med Spa Association reported October 29.

Why it matters: HHS says it does not intend to act against state-licensed pharmacies, federal facilities and licensed physicians compounding the six while FDA considers adding them to the 503A bulks list. Conditions include an FDA-registered CGMP manufacturer, certificates of analysis, adverse-event reporting, a single listed active ingredient and a patient-specific prescription. The peptides are not FDA-approved, and this is not a blanket authorization to prescribe or administer. Before you stock any of them, get your pharmacy's safeguards in writing and check your state board's position.

AmSpa: HHS interim enforcement discretion, six peptides

REGULATION

The Arkansas State Board of Nursing's 30-day comment period on revised position statements for nurses in medical aesthetics and IV hydration closed October 19, and neither revision had been adopted as of American Med Spa Association's October 13 report.

Why it matters: American Med Spa Association reported October 13 that Position Statement 21-1 covers nurses in aesthetic, cosmetic and dermatological procedures and 26-1 covers nurses in IV hydration. AmSpa says the revisions could affect nursing responsibilities and expectations for providers who use nurses for these services; the full requirements are in the board's draft PDFs. If you employ nurses in Arkansas, read both drafts and compare them with your delegation language and standing orders before the board acts.

AmSpa: Arkansas nursing board comment deadline

CHIROPRACTIC & PHYSICAL THERAPY

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

The final 2027 fee schedule sets the annual therapy threshold at $2,540 for PT and speech combined and $2,540 for OT, and keeps the targeted medical review threshold at $3,000 through 2027.

Why it matters: AHCA summarized the rule November 5. DocWire's table of CMS specialty estimates shows physical and occupational therapy relative value units up 3%; that estimate excludes the conversion factor, which falls 2.31% for most clinicians and 1.83% for qualifying APM participants. Pull your 2026 Medicare caseload by patient and code, list who is near $2,540 and who is near $3,000, and rerun 2027 revenue at the lower conversion factor of $32.6286.

AHCA: What's in the PFS and home health final rules · DocWire: what the 2027 final rule means for physicians

INSURANCE

APTA said in a November 4 article that commercial payers are bringing back multiple procedure payment reduction policies, which payers began adopting in 2011.

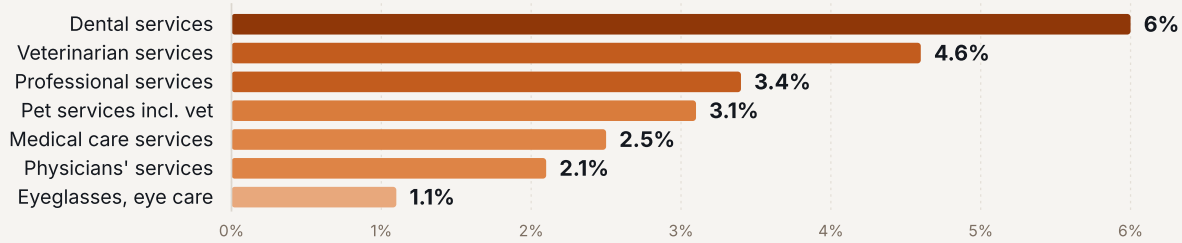
Why it matters: APTA's article says commercial payers followed Medicare's lead on multiple procedure payment reduction in 2011, and that what is new is the pace at which the policies are resurfacing. Search your payer contracts and last two bulletins for "multiple procedure" and "MPPR," and ask each payer in writing whether a reduction applies to same-day therapy codes. APTA's payer-policy webinar is November 19 at 2:30 p.m. Eastern, free to PT members.

APTA: the fight against MPPR isn't over · APTA Learning Center: payment updates, November 2026

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / TRADE PRICES, SEPTEMBER

Dental fees ran 6.0% above a year earlier in September, veterinary fees 4.6% and eyeglasses and eye care 1.1%.

BLS Consumer Price Index, September 2026 news release, issued October 14, 2026, Table 2: unadjusted percent change, September 2025 to September 2026.



Dental services rose 3.9 points faster than physicians' services (2.1%) and veterinarian services 4.6% against 3.1% for pet services including veterinary. Eye care rose 1.1%. Compare your own 2026 fee changes with these rates before you set 2027 fees and sign payer renewals. BLS CPI September 2026, Table 2

OPTOMETRY & VISION

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

The 2027 Medicare fee schedule sets the optometry conversion factor at $32.63 and pays the lower-paid service 80% when an exam and a 0-day procedure share a date, Optometry Times reported November 5.

Why it matters: The higher-paid service, visit or procedure, gets 100%. CMS had proposed 50% and included 10- and 90-day global procedures; both were narrowed after comment, and 10- and 90-day procedures are excluded. The article advises checking each procedure's global indicator in the final rule (document 2026-22743). Take your 2026 Medicare claims where an exam and a minor procedure shared a date, look up each procedure's global period, and price the 20% cut on the 0-day ones. The conversion factor falls 2.31% from $33.40.

Optometry Times: 2027 fee schedule trims same-day pay · DocWire: what the 2027 final rule means for physicians

DEMAND

Two Indiana optometrists opened the state's first OD-owned surgical suites on October 29 and 30, where contracted surgeons perform cataract surgery and refractive lens exchange inside their own practices.

Why it matters: Optometry Times reported November 4 that Christopher Browning, OD, and Nicholas Garn, OD, built the suites with iOR Partners and each contracts with a surgeon. Browning found he had referred more than 30 cataract patients a month. Per the announcement, an optometrist cannot own an ambulatory surgery center but can own an office-based surgery suite. Garn named surgeon contracts, cost estimates and a femtosecond laser as the hurdles. Count your monthly cataract referrals and confirm your state's ownership rules before pricing a build.

Optometry Times: Indiana ODs open surgical suites

BEHAVIORAL & MENTAL HEALTH

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

A federal judge in Massachusetts vacated CMS's "significantly impairs" test for Medicaid medically frail status on October 29, giving the 25 plaintiff states and D.C. six months to rework verification.

Why it matters: Judge Richard Stearns found CMS exceeded its authority by adding the test to the five categories Congress set. The 12-month lookback on claims and visit data and the limit on self-attestation still apply, work requirements remain scheduled for January 1, and CMS could appeal. A separate suit by enrollees and provider groups was filed in September. If Medicaid patients are a large share of your caseload, make sure diagnoses and visits from the past 12 months are billed and documented, and ask your state agency in writing how it will identify frail patients.

Healthcare Dive: judge strikes CMS medical frailty rule · Becker's Payer: judge rules CMS overstepped on frailty

REGULATION

NABH said October 27 that it worked with Rep. Mike Kelly on H.R. 10876, which would repeal the IPF Patient Assessment Instrument and temporarily raise Behavioral Health Integration reimbursement for 2027 through 2029.

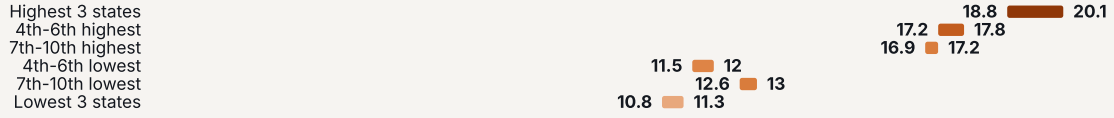
Why it matters: The Behavioral Health Care Deregulation Act of 2026 would also remove Medicare cost-sharing for involuntary psychiatric commitments, remove the 190-day lifetime limit on inpatient psychiatric services and direct HHS to help primary care practices adopt integration models starting January 1, 2027. NABH estimates the assessment instrument would cost $304 million in its first year. The bill is a proposal, and NABH represents behavioral hospitals. If you bill Behavioral Health Integration codes, ask your specialty association whether it supports the bill.

NABH Insider: October 27 and November 3 issues

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / DENTAL AFFORDABILITY

Households in the 10 costliest states work 16.9 to 20.1 hours to cover one person's dental care; in the 10 cheapest, 10.8 to 13.0.

Dental Reviewed Dental Care Affordability Index, hours of household work per person's annual dental care, as published by Becker's Dental Review on October 19, 2026. Bars span the lowest and highest state in each rank group.

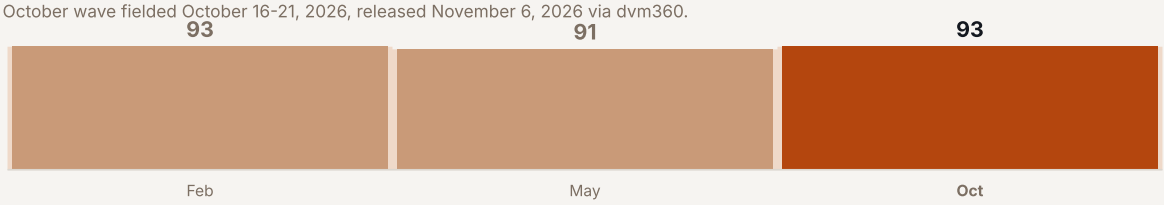


The U.S. average is 14.2 hours. South Dakota is highest at 20.1, Wyoming 19.8 and North Dakota 18.8; Maryland is second lowest at 11.0, behind Rhode Island at 10.8. Becker's reports only the top and bottom 10 states; the index compares dental spending with median household income in each state. Compare your state with the average before setting payment-plan and financing terms. Becker's Dental: states with highest dental work burden

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / PET SPENDING OUTLOOK

Pet owners expecting to keep spending on pet health level or raise it over the next year were 93% in October, up from 91% in May.

Elanco Pet Health Trends Omnibus, share of dog and cat owners expecting level or higher pet health spending over the next year; October wave fielded October 16-21, 2026, released November 6, 2026 via dvm360.



The share expecting level or higher spending was 93% in February, 91% in May and 93% in October. Only 7% of owners said they would cut pet health spending if money got tight. Elanco sells pet health products and ran the survey online. dvm360: pet health is the last expense owners cut

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

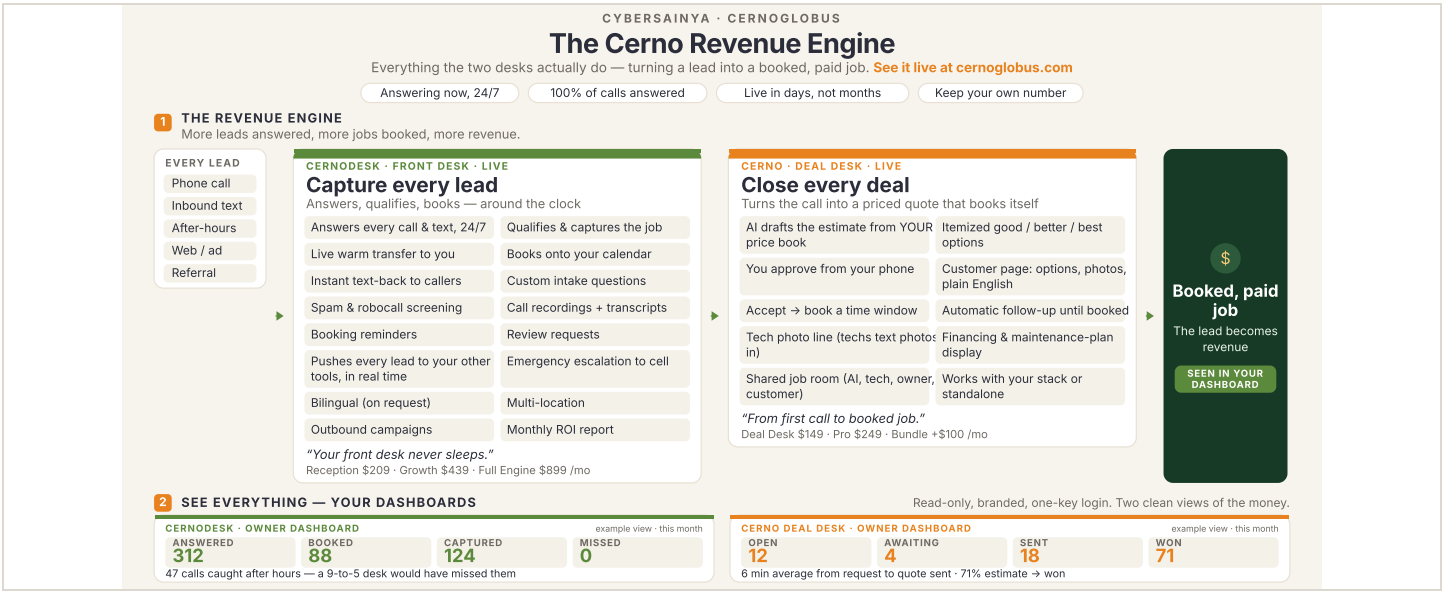
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern an independent practice. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A practice that emails claims, statements and supplier invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



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